

The person in this book is still here.

Some of what they know is going, and it's going in an order nobody chose: this morning first, and 1961 last. Still Me goes where the memory is strongest, and writes down what it finds there, in their words, while they can still say them.

It has two halves. The first is their story, told one page at a time at the kitchen table or the bedside: the house, the mother, the work, the songs, the dog. The second is for whoever cares for them: what calms them, what upsets them, what they eat, the names they'll ask for and what the family has agreed to say. A two-minute page at the front of it can be read by a night nurse at a shift change.

It begins with a short guide to doing this well: how to ask, when to stop, what to do with a wrong answer, and a page for the person holding the pen.

Nothing in it has to be finished. A page with three words on it is a good page.

For families, care homes, hospitals, and hospice teams.
Filled in together.

STILL ME

A life-story book, filled in together.